



1000-5 (Br Adj)

May 2025

BAC Membership

BRANCH ADVISORY COUNCIL  
RECORD OF DISCUSSION – 23 APR 2025

### RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

| Position / Appointment                        | Rank & Name                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Chair / Branch Leader</b>                  | Major-General Dave Yarker                                  |
| <b>Co-Chair / Branch Advisor</b>              | Colonel Steeve Lavoie                                      |
| <b>Member / Colonel Commandant</b>            | Brigadier-General Martin Girard (Retired)                  |
| <b>Member / Branch Chief</b>                  | Chief Warrant Officer Renay Groves                         |
| <b>Member / General Officer</b>               | Brigadier-General Francois Robichaud                       |
| <b>Member / General Officer</b>               | Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout                           |
| <b>Member / General Officer</b>               | Brigadier-General Walter Norquay                           |
| <b>Member / General Officer</b>               | Brigadier-General Mark Parsons                             |
| <b>Member / General Officer</b>               | Brigadier-General Justin Thibert                           |
| <b>Member / Strategic A6</b>                  | Colonel Guy Parisien                                       |
| <b>Member / Director RCCS</b>                 | Colonel Walter Jull                                        |
| <b>Member / Director RCCS NCM</b>             | Colonel Marc Prince (Regrets)                              |
| <b>Member / Director SIGINT</b>               | Colonel John Roper (Regrets)                               |
| <b>Member / Home Station Commandant</b>       | Lieutenant-Colonel Geneviève Audet                         |
| <b>Member / Corps Chief</b>                   | Chief Warrant Officer Trevor McInnis<br>(Regrets)          |
| <b>Member / STA</b>                           | Chief Warrant Officer Jeremie Doucet                       |
| <b>Member / STA</b>                           | Chief Petty Officer 1 <sup>st</sup> Class Geoffrey Whitten |
| <b>Member / STA</b>                           | Chief Warrant Officer Graham Bell                          |
| <b>Member / Home Station RSM</b>              | Chief Warrant Officer Jason McQuigge                       |
| <b>Member / Subaltern of the Year</b>         | Captain Saad Khattak (Regrets)                             |
| <b>Member / Member of the Year</b>            | Sergeant Jeremie Choquette                                 |
| <b>Secretariat / Branch Adjutant</b>          | Major Gregory McDonald                                     |
| <b>Guest / Primary Reserve Representative</b> | Lieutenant-Colonel Lisa Smid                               |
| <b>Guest / Primary Reserve Representative</b> | Chief Warrant Officer Gerald Umbach                        |
| <b>Guest / Special Advisor, DSG</b>           | Major-General Dave Neasmith (Retired)                      |

## RECORD OF DISCUSSION

### INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

1. The discussion opened with a brief introduction from the Branch Leader.

### INCOMING BRANCH APPOINTMENTS & INCUMBENTS

2. The Branch Advisor identified that the incoming Branch Adjutant will be Major Emilie Circe. The Branch Advisor also noted that the Branch Affairs Officer, Branch Chief Clerk and Branch Bandmaster positions are vacant. Finally, a Class A position is approved and being created for a LCol to oversee the Branch 125<sup>th</sup> Anniversary planning and execution. The Branch Leader indicated that filling the Bandmaster position might be successful if the focus is on “administration” of the band instead of the “musical” aspect.

### C&E WEEK 2025

3. **Lessons Learned:** The Branch Advisor identified the Lessons Learned from C&E Week 2024 and highlighted the work done this year to improve them.
4. **C&E Week Detailed Schedule** – The Branch Advisor presented an overview of the three COAs for C&E Week 2025 before the Branch Adjutant provided a detailed description of each. Discussion ensued which included emphasis on A Res inclusion (opportunities for participation on the weekend), support for having C&E Week split between the NCR and Kingston, and support for CAPCON and the RCCS Conference running on the Wednesday and Thursday. Creating activities for more regional (non-NCR or Kingston-based activities) was generally supported, however more work is required to consider identification of the lead (Div G6s will most likely be in NCR/KGN for week), the activities they are asked to lead, potential funding for A Res participation, and how this impacts any pre-planned regional PD activities based on C&E Week that occur shortly after. The membership decided that COA 1 is not supported and to further develop the other COAs for a decision prior to July 2025.

### ACTION ITEM(s):

1. **Branch Office:** Investigate potential for funding regional A Res participation.
2. **Branch Office:** Further develop C&E Week COAs based on Kingston/NCR split and regional participation and seek secretarial COA decision from the BAC prior to July 2025.
3. **Branch Office:** Develop C&E Week 2025 General Instruction.

### BRANCH AMBASSADOR PROGRAM

5. The Branch Chief introduced a new initiative, the Branch Ambassador Program. The purpose of the program is to enable keen C&E members across all C&E occupations to contribute to and support the C&E Branch. The Branch Ambassadors will be selected from a pool of applicant candidates through a GBA+ lens and with the right attributes. The Branch Ambassadors will help organize C&E Branch activities, support communication efforts and participate in training. Discussion ensued where it was highlighted that Branch Ambassadors are selected volunteer members that should represent the diversity of C&E Branch members. Their training will consist of, among other topics, Trusted to Serve and

Fighting Spirit. The success of the program with pre-OFP members was discussed, highlighting the value of this program. It was also suggested that perhaps the Branch Ambassador program should replace the Subbies and Sgts INDOC during C&E Week, to which the Branch Chief agreed.

**ACTION ITEM(s):**

4. **Branch Chief:** Develop Branch Ambassador Program activities for C&E Week 2025.

**STRATEGIC J6 DISCUSSION**

6. Major-General Dave Neasmith (Retired), Special Advisor to DSG, presented the CAF J6 Functional Review, highlighting that “Strategic J6” might be a more appropriate title. The problems and proposed solutions focused on getting the “function” right were briefed. A detailed discussion followed the presentation which included the importance of authorities, the recognition of authorities by others, the potential credibility challenges for the Branch in consideration of the “Strategic J6” role, where the role could sit, the relationship between Strategic J6, DSG, and SSC, and the probable evolution of the role and function over the long-term. The discussion concluded with a request to receive comments on the review.

**ACTION ITEM(s):**

1. **BAC Membership:** Provide comments on CAF J6 Functional Review to Major-General Dave Neasmith (Retired).

**CAF CYBER TRAINING UNIT**

7. The Cyber Operator Senior Trade Advisor provided a brief on the current state of the CAF Cyber Training Unit evolution. The Training Unit will continue to grow, incorporating Cyber and SIGINT training. The TO&E is currently being developed for the unit. Unique Specialty Qualifications are also being considered for Officers, with these courses currently being developed with the support of CFSCE in consideration of the need for the training within Signals.

**BRANCH OFFICE UPDATE**

8. The Branch Adjutant provided a financial update on the Branch Office’s FY24/25 spending and the planned budget for FY25/26. A recommendation to change the C&E Educational Bursary to a Micro-Bursary for serving members was provided. Finally, upcoming timelines for H&R submissions and Branch activities up to July 2025 were presented. A discussion on the Micro-Bursary recommendation ensued including the requirement to engage spouses of the C&E Family to make them aware of the Educational Bursary, concerns about eliminating a program that can benefit dependents, concerns about the micro-grant amount, that each have differing goals (support family members of the community, and increase engagement of junior C&E Branch members), and making a change without securing C&E Family feedback. Potential options proposed were to maintain the Educational Bursary but reconsider criteria, increase the amount of the Micro-Bursary, and to split the funding between Educational Bursary and Micro-Bursary programs.

**ACTION ITEM(s):**

1. **Branch Office:** Maintain Educational Bursary for this year and solicit applications.
2. **Branch Office:** Provide new proposal with options at the next BAC.
3. **Subbie of the Year and Member of the Year:** Solicit feedback from C&E Branch members on new proposal.

**OPEN FORUM / ROUND TABLE / QUESTION PERIOD**

9. The Branch Chief identified that a lot of C&E Branch activities are shared through her Facebook page “Groves CWO Renay Groves” and encouraged all to check it out. The Colonel Commandant mentioned that he and the Branch Chief travelled to 35 Signal Regiment, QGET and 34 Signal Regiment, and that our troops are amazing and doing amazing things. The Colonel Commandant will visit Ottawa on 12-13 May and Kingston on 12-13 June. Further, the Colonel Commandant found the files from the 100<sup>th</sup> Anniversary, which he intends to scan and share.

**CLOSING REMARKS**

10. The Branch Leader concluded the meeting by highlighting the need to have the 125<sup>th</sup> Anniversary Class A position filled, the C&E Senate meeting occurring on 13 May, and thanking everyone for their participation.

**YARKER,  
DAVID 516**

Digitally signed by  
YARKER, DAVID 516  
Date: 2025.06.24  
14:50:07 -04'00'

---

**Major-General Dave Yarker, CD  
Branch Leader**



Digitally signed by  
LAVOIE, STEEVE 773  
Date: 2025.06.05  
10:24:08 -04'00'

---

**Colonel Steeve Lavoie, CD  
Branch Advisor**

Annex                      Branch Advisory Council Slide Deck